

PRAYERS THAT PREVAIL FOR THE LOST

TEXT: [Hosea 1:1-3](#) (NLT) ***“The LORD gave these messages to Hosea son of Beeri during the years when Uzziah, Jotham, Ahaz, and Hezekiah were kings of Judah, and Jeroboam son of Jehoash was king of Israel. 2 When the LORD first began speaking to Israel through Hosea, he said to him, “Go and marry a prostitute, so some of her children will be born to you from other men. This will illustrate the way my people have been untrue to me, openly committing adultery against the LORD by worshiping other gods.” 3 So Hosea married Gomer, the daughter of Diblaim, and she became pregnant and gave Hosea a son.”***

In this series we will be learning how to pray for our loved ones more effectively. In my opinion the book of Hosea gives some tremendous lessons on this subject. This book is not at all the kind of plot you would expect to find in the Bible. Hosea is a prophet to Israel and God instructs him to marry a harlot!

I don't know about you but if God were to speak a thing like that to me I would want to be absolutely sure I had my ears on correctly! I would want to place some fleeces before the Lord and give Him ample opportunity to straiten me out or change His mind!

Always remember, when God speaks a thing to us He has a perfectly good reason for doing so. [Isaiah 55:6-9](#) (NLT) ***“Seek the LORD while you can find him. Call on him now while he is near. 7 Let the people turn from their wicked deeds. Let them banish from their minds the very thought of doing wrong! Let them turn to the LORD that he may have mercy on them. Yes, turn to our God, for he will abundantly pardon. 8 “My thoughts are completely different from yours,” says the LORD. “And my ways are far beyond anything you could imagine. 9 For just as the heavens are higher than the earth, so are my ways higher than your ways and my thoughts higher than***

your thoughts.” Psalm 77:13 (CEV) *“Everything you do is right, and no other god compares with you.”* Daniel repeats this same phrase in Daniel 9:7.

Even though His ways are superior to our ways and He never makes a mistake, this set of instructions seems to fall into the unreasonable category! This is without a doubt, unreasonable but He is oftentimes an unreasonable God. God has proven Himself to be unreasonable in the following ways:

- He was unreasonable about reconciling man to Himself!
- He was unreasonable regarding sending His Son Jesus!
- He was unreasonable concerning the sacrifice for sin!
- He will be unreasonable with regard to the judgment for sin!

God’s instructions to Hosea are not just edgy they are completely off the page!

Think of this:

- The Pastor’s wife is a harlot!
- Can you imagine the dizzying volume of the rumor mill?
- Can you see her sashaying down the isle on Sunday morning dressed inappropriately?
- Can you imagine the caution of the other ladies with regard to their husband’s relationship with the pastor and his family?
- Can you imagine the ridicule their children received?

Looking at this purely from a logical perspective it would appear that nothing good could flow out of this relationship. Therefore, this surely could not be the will of God! Try explaining that theological philosophy to Abraham who was asked to take his son Isaac to the mountain!

Here God speaks to the prophet to marry this lady of ill repute! Hosea 1:2 (NLT) *“When the LORD first began speaking to*

Israel through Hosea, he said to him, “Go and marry a prostitute...”

What could God possibly be thinking? What good could come out of this? How would He sustain Hosea’s ministry? How could God get glory from the obedience of the prophet in this scenario?

Always remember, every time God speaks He has a way designed for His directives to turn out for the good. In this case He was going to use the marriage relationship between the prophet and the prostitute to teach the prophet what God desired to do to restore the relationship between Jehovah and the wayward nation of Israel. [Hosea 1:2 \(NLT\)](#) ***“When the LORD first began speaking to Israel through Hosea, he said to him, “Go and marry a prostitute, so some of her children will be born to you from other men. This will illustrate the way my people have been untrue to me, openly committing adultery against the LORD by worshiping other gods.”***

As this book begins to unfold and the storyline becomes more apparent the student begins to see the love of God for fallen man.

(PLACE THE WORDS OF THIS SONG ON THE SCREEN AS WELL AS THE PAGE NUMBER OF WHERE IT CAN BE FOUND IN THE HYMN BOOK)

(SONG: THE LOVE OF GOD)

1) The love of God is greater far, than tongue or pen can ever tell; it goes beyond the highest star, and reaches to the lowest hell; the guilty pair, bowed down with care, God gave His Son to win; his erring child He reconciled, and pardoned from his sin.

2) When years of time shall pass away, and earthly thrones and kingdoms fall, when men who here refuse to pray, on rocks and hills and mountains call, God’s love so sure shall still endure, all measureless and strong; redeeming grace to Adam’s race

the saints' and angels' song.

3) Could we with ink the ocean fill, and were the skies of parchment made, were every stalk on earth a quill, and every man a scribe by trade, to write the love of God above would drain the ocean dry; nor could the scroll contain the whole, tho' stretched from sky to sky.

(Chorus)

O love of God, how rich and pure! How measureless and strong! It shall for evermore endure, the saints' and angels' song!

Make no mistake about it God's love calls upon His church to be obedient to the Heavenly calling of winning others to Christ.

John 3:16 (KJV) *"For God so loved the world, that he gave his only begotten Son, that whosoever believeth in him should not perish, but have everlasting life."*

In This story of the prophet and the prostitute we can gain some wonderful insight into what we can do to free our loved ones from Satan's power. Do you have family members or friends who are bound by Satan's power? Would you like to see them freed? Would you like to be able to participate in the process of their emancipation from Satan's power?

Over the next few weeks I am going to give you some insights that the Lord has revealed to me from the book of Hosea. I am confident these truths will change the theory of your life as it pertains to your faith for your family and friends, as well as your own personal activity with regard to their release.

I believe the Word of God teaches the concept of household salvation. **Joshua 24:14-15 (NLT) *"So honor the LORD and serve him wholeheartedly. Put away forever the idols your ancestors worshiped when they lived beyond the Euphrates River and in Egypt. Serve the LORD alone. 15 But if you are unwilling to serve the LORD, then choose today whom you will serve. Would you prefer the gods your ancestors served***

beyond the Euphrates? Or will it be the gods of the Amorites in whose land you now live? But as for me and my family, we will serve the LORD.” At times when my children have not been living like they should, I have told both of them “*Everyone is going to Heaven from this house; no-one is going to hell from here.*”

Nelsons Bible Dictionary makes the following observation with regard to the Biblical definition of a “Household”: *“All the people who lived together in the same family in Bible times. Israelite families were larger than ours today. The family included the immediate family and all who lived together in the same house. This included slaves, concubines, foreign residents, and servants. When Abraham circumcised all the males in his household, he included his servants and slaves. The household and their possessions moved as a unit. When Obed–Edom kept the ark, he and his household were given a special blessing by David. In the New Testament, entire households were sometimes baptized together.”*

We need to get our minds made up that everyone connected to us will be going to Heaven and then work on developing a prayer life that reflects our intentions!

It is my desire that every family connected to Christian Temple will experience household salvation! I pray that your family circle will not be broken on the Day of Judgment. I also want this to be a church whose growth is primarily driven by salvations rather than transferees from other churches.

If we are to accomplish these goals we must get serious about reaching the lost. The first step to reaching the lost is to pray for the lost! I want to remind us that the lost will not be saved unless they have been prayed for! [Ezekiel 22:29-31](#) (NKJV) ***“The people of the land have used oppressions, committed robbery, and mistreated the poor and needy; and they wrongfully oppress the stranger.³⁰ “So I sought for a man among them who would make a wall, and stand in the gap before Me on behalf of the land, that I should not destroy it;***

but I found no one.³¹ “Therefore I have poured out My indignation on them; I have consumed them with the fire of My wrath; and I have recompensed their deeds on their own heads,” says the Lord GOD.” 1 Timothy 2:1-4 (NLT) ***“I urge you, first of all, to pray for all people. As you make your requests, plead for God’s mercy upon them, and give thanks. 2 Pray this way for kings and all others who are in authority, so that we can live in peace and quietness, in godliness and dignity. 3 This is good and pleases God our Savior, 4 for he wants everyone to be saved and to understand the truth.”***

We are not going to just pray for the lost we are going to build ourselves a “*Hit List*” which includes the name of every person with whom the people of this church are concerned. We will also keep a “*Ten Most Wanted List*” which will be driven by the amount of times the persons name appears on the request cards over the next four Sunday evenings.

Do not place a persons name on a card unless you are willing to take personal responsibility to pray for that individual everyday; agree to do everything in your power to personally bring that individual to Christ!

CARDS:

- Place only one name on a card...
- Fill out only one card each Sunday evening...

The “*Hit List*” and the “*Ten Most Wanted List*” will be:

- Prayed over at all church sponsored prayer meetings...
- Given to selected individuals to pray over each day...
- Given to a group of intercessors for the purpose of intercession...

